

English Question Bank Topics Guide

A structured revision sheet based on the idioms, phrasal verbs, prepositions, grammar patterns, and phobias that appear in the question bank.

How to use this guide: read the topic name, learn the meaning, then memorize the example pattern. The goal is to recognize the expression quickly inside a sentence.

1. Idioms About People, Attitudes, and Situations

Topic	Meaning / Use
caught red-handed	caught while doing something wrong
pay no heed	ignore something
barking up the wrong tree	accusing or blaming the wrong person
good riddance	relief that someone or something is gone
the elephant in the room	an obvious problem that people avoid mentioning
cry me a river	a sarcastic way to dismiss complaints
not my cup of tea	not something you like or enjoy
I concur	I agree
I second the motion	I support the proposal or idea

2. Money, Business, and Profit Idioms

Topic	Meaning / Use
break the bank	cost far too much money
cost an arm and a leg	be extremely expensive
in the red	losing money or having debt
in the black	making money or financially healthy
rolling in money / rolling in dough	very rich
money to burn	having more money than needed
loaded	very rich
avoid breaking the bank	avoid spending too much

3. Time, Frequency, and Sudden Events

Topic	Meaning / Use
once in a blue moon	very rarely
out of the blue	suddenly and without warning

in the nick of time	just before it is too late
speak of the devil	said when someone appears just after being mentioned

4. Study, Exams, and School Idioms

Topic	Meaning / Use
hit the books	study hard
cram	study a lot in a very short time
pull an all-nighter	stay awake all night to study or work
take a test cold	take a test without preparation
mind goes blank	you suddenly cannot remember anything
do well on a test	get a good result
stay up late	go to bed much later than usual
burn the midnight oil	work or study late into the night

5. Phrasal Verbs and Fixed Verbal Expressions

Topic	Meaning / Use
hand in	submit something, especially homework or a paper
hand out	distribute something
hand back	return something to its owner
turn in	submit or hand in
get away with	avoid punishment for something wrong
get through to someone	successfully persuade or communicate with someone
buckle down	start working seriously
stick it out	continue doing something difficult until the end
sleep on it	wait before making a decision
take someone up on an offer	accept an offer
fool around with	experiment casually or behave playfully
wander around	walk without a fixed destination

6. Prepositions in Common Collocations

Topic	Meaning / Use
dawned on me	I suddenly realized something
on the edge of your seat	very excited or intensely interested

spark interest in	cause interest in something
have no bearing on	have no connection to something
from my standpoint / point of view	from my opinion or perspective
as far as I know	to the extent of my knowledge
bone of contention	a subject of disagreement
blow something out of proportion	make something seem bigger or worse than it is
hold water	be logical or valid
leave a lot to be desired	be unsatisfactory

7. Feelings, States, and Reaction Idioms

Topic	Meaning / Use
wiped out	extremely tired
all ears	listening carefully
a second wind	new energy after fatigue
music to my ears	very pleasant or welcome news
hit home	become deeply understood or emotionally real
in a rut	stuck in a boring routine
ups and downs	good and bad periods
all stretched out	lying down or elongated
jet lag	tiredness after long travel across time zones
drive someone up the wall	make someone very angry
at the end of your rope	at the limit of patience or energy
keep a level head	stay calm and sensible
lose your head	panic or act irrationally
knock yourself out	exert a lot of effort
make do	manage with what is available
sit tight	stay where you are and wait calmly
dwel on	think too much about something, often a negative issue
come through	survive or succeed in a difficult situation

8. Phobias and Fear Vocabulary

Topic	Meaning / Use
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claustrophobia	fear of enclosed spaces
acrophobia	fear of heights
cynophobia	fear of dogs
ailurophobia	fear of cats
aerophobia	fear of flying
hemophobia	fear of blood
hydrophobia	fear of water
autophobia	fear of being alone
phobic	a person who suffers from a phobia

9. Grammar and Article Patterns

Topic	Meaning / Use
an awful lot	use 'an' before the adjective phrase; the full expression is often followed by 'of'
a lot of	a very common quantity phrase
get a grade on a test	use 'on' with tests and exams
do well in/at school	school expressions often need fixed prepositions
good at / do well on	different structures are used for skills and exam performance
I got an A	use 'an' before the letter A when naming a grade
mind went blank	a fixed expression describing memory failure
what it boils down to	the conclusion or main point

10. High-Value Review Points

Topic	Meaning / Use
Meaning first, word second	many answers depend on the exact idiom meaning, not literal translation
Watch fixed prepositions	small words like on, in, at, to, and of often decide the correct answer
Know the collocations	some verbs only naturally fit with certain nouns
Check verb tense	questions often mix idiom knowledge with past tense or present tense
Choose the natural expression	the best answer is usually the most native-sounding phrase